

HSC BUSINESS STUDIES

Human Resources

Practice questions by syllabus point

95 questions · 0 shown as screenshots of the printed paper · 20 of 24 syllabus points covered

Drawn from 23 papers: NESA HSC 2019–2023, school trial papers 2023–24, and topic question banks.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

- Questions sit under the syllabus dot point they actually test, in syllabus order.
- Ruled space follows each question, sized to its mark value — write straight onto the page, on paper or with a stylus.
- A question testing more than one dot point is printed once and cross-referenced from the others.
- Where a scan of the original page exists it is shown as-is, so you see the real layout and mark boxes.

CONTENTS

Role of human resource management

Strategic role of human resource management	2
Interdependence with other key business functions	3
Outsourcing	8

Influences

Stakeholders	6
Legal — the employment contract	10
Legal — work health and safety and workers compensation	1
Legal — anti-discrimination and equal employment opportunity	3
Economic influences	2
Technological influences	2
Social influences	2
Ethics and corporate social responsibility	4

Processes of human resource management

Acquisition	3
Development	—
Maintenance	—
Separation	1

Strategies in human resource management

Leadership style	2
Job design	—
Recruitment	—
Training and development	2
Performance management	1
Rewards	1
Global	1
Workplace disputes	6

Effectiveness of human resource management

Indicators	9
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PART 1

Role of human resource management

Strategic role of human resource management

1. 24 (a) Roseville Trial 2023 2 marks

Outline the strategic role of human resource management.

2. 24 (a) Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 2 marks

Outline the strategic role of the human resource function.

Also tested by questions 14, 15.

Interdependence with other key business functions

3. Learn to 5 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Explain the interdependence between human resources and other key business functions.

4. Qu 21 (a) HSC Final Exam Preparation — MARKETING

3 marks

Outline the interdependence of marketing and human resources.

5. 24 (c) Abbotsleigh Trial 2023

4 marks

Using the data, analyse the interdependence between human resources management and financial management in this business.

STIMULUS
Table of data for a business, 2021 vs 2022. Human Resources costs: \$2 600 000 (2021) vs \$2 000 000 (2022). Training expenditure per employee: \$1900 vs \$1500. Absenteeism per employee: 10 days vs 14 days. Accidents per 1000 employees: 50 vs 30. Number of strike days: 2 vs 10. Staff turnover: 15% vs 10%.

Also tested by questions 15, 16, 17, 18.

Outsourcing — HR functions, using contractors (domestic, global)

6. Learn to 7 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of outsourcing in the global market.

7. 24 (a) Roseville Trial 2024

1 mark

Identify one human resource function that Green Earth Ltd could outsource.

STIMULUS

Green Earth Ltd is a mid-sized manufacturing company that produces eco-friendly household products. Due to rapid growth and an increase in customer demand, the company's management team is considering outsourcing certain human resource functions to improve efficiency and focus on core activities.

8. 24 (a) Barker Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline ONE disadvantage of outsourcing human resources functions.

9. 24 (b) Roseville Trial 2023

2 marks

Describe ONE benefit that might result from deciding to outsource an aspect of human resource management.

10. 23 (b) 2021 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Why might a business use a contractor to recruit staff?

11. 24 (b) Barker Trial 2023

3 marks

Why would a business outsource their human resource functions?

12. 24 (b) Roseville Trial 2024

4 marks

Describe two benefits this company might experience from outsourcing this human resource function.

STIMULUS

Green Earth Ltd is a mid-sized manufacturing company that produces eco-friendly household products. Due to rapid growth and an increase in customer demand, the company's management team is considering outsourcing certain human resource functions to improve efficiency and focus on core activities.

13. Question 22 (a) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

4 marks

Outline TWO benefits of outsourcing key human resource functions for this business.

STIMULUS

A manufacturing business operating across Australia employs a large workforce. Management decides to outsource key human resource functions including recruitment, induction, change management, training and development of employees. Recently there has been an industrial dispute with employees demanding higher pay, and better working conditions.

Also tested by question 19.

PART 1 · EXTENDED RESPONSE

Role of human resource management — 20-mark questions

6 questions. Plan and write these on separate paper.

14. 27 Newington Trial 2023**20 marks**

Evaluate how a business has used strategies in human resource management to sustain a competitive advantage.

15. 25 Barker Trial 2023**20 marks**

Management of Marvels Metals has hired you as a consultant to write a report addressing:

- Outline the strategic role of human resources management for this business.
- Examine the interdependence between finance and human resources for this business.
- Recommend ONE appropriate financial management strategy to address the business' financial problems.

STIMULUS

Marvel Metals manufactures metal products for the Australian building industry. Over the past few years, the business has experienced decreasing profitability and cash flow management problems. Rising inflation has affected a range of their costs such as raw materials, utilities and wages. They have also noticed significant delays in receiving payment from their customers. Management is looking to adopt new technology, which will result in job cuts and retraining for some staff. Employees are unhappy with this potential change and it is contributing to increasing rates of absenteeism and staff turnover.

16. 25 Barker Trial 2024**20 marks**

Management of Harmony Co has hired you as a consultant to write a report addressing:

- Explain how human resources management is interdependent with marketing.
- Demonstrate why monitoring and controlling should be used to manage their marketing processes.
- Recommend ONE appropriate marketing strategy to address the business' problems.

STIMULUS

Harmony Co is a well-known Australian company specialising in eco-friendly skincare and vitamin supplement products. The company has built a loyal customer base by emphasising natural ingredients and operates 18 stores with a team of 200 employees across product development, retail and customer service. Harmony Co had seen steady sales growth over the past five years, but recent quarters have shown a 15% decline in revenue. They hold a 5% share in the eco-friendly product segment but are concerned about competition from new entrants and established brands. The answer must be presented in the form of a business report.

17. 25 Roseville Trial 2024**20 marks**

You have been hired as a consultant by Toyland Ltd to write a business report for the owners.

In your report:

- Outline the interdependence between human resources and marketing at Toyland.
- Describe methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff.
- Discuss global marketing strategies that Toyland could use as it continues to expand globally.

STIMULUS

Toyland Ltd is a successful toy manufacturing company that has expanded globally into many countries around the world. Sales revenue has been increasing rapidly, which has placed pressure on their production volumes as they have found it difficult to keep up with demand due to staff shortages. They sell their toys via their website, which allows customers to order directly from them. They are intending on having a once-off 'mega sale' which only applies to purchases made on a specific day next month. Toyland Ltd makes a wide range of toys but has recently been heavily focused on the manufacturing of toy merchandise associated with large blockbuster movies that are targeted towards children.

18. Question 25 Roseville Trial 2023**20 marks**

You have been hired as a consultant by ACB Pty Ltd to write a business report to the owners.

In your report:

- outline how human resources is interdependent with finance in this business.
- explain the limitations of financial reports that this business must be aware of when purchasing the 5 existing American retail sporting stores.
- recommend global financial management strategies that could help to reduce financial risks for this business.

STIMULUS

Aussie Cricket Bats (ACB) Pty Ltd is an Australian cricket bat manufacturing company hoping to cash in on the newfound popularity of the sport in America by selling cricket bats into that market. ACB plans to sell to Americans via (1) its already well-established Australian website, (2) taking ownership over 5 existing retail sporting stores on the east coast of America, and (3) becoming a supplier of bats to other established American sporting retail chains. To fund these plans ACB needs to borrow the equivalent of \$15 million Australian Dollars. The owners are unsure whether to borrow in Australian Dollars from an Australian bank or in US Dollars from an American bank, and are worried about how to staff the 5 American retail stores as well as potentially paying too much for those businesses because they lack accounting expertise.

19. 25 Abbotsleigh Trial 2023**20 marks**

You have been employed as a consultant by Boating and Floating Ltd. to prepare a report that will be given to their management team. In your report, you should:

- Describe the advantages of outsourcing the human resource function in a global market for Boating and Floating Ltd.
- Explain the importance of a situational analysis for Boating and Floating Ltd. as they plan their international expansion.
- Analyse the implementation of global marketing strategies for Boating and Floating Ltd. to effectively launch their products on the global market.

STIMULUS

Boating and Floating Ltd. is an Australian manufacturer of boating accessory products that are made from sustainable plastics. The business is planning to launch their products onto the global market, using inputs and materials specific to the local global regions. Boating and Floating Ltd. is considering effective promotional strategies that could be implemented for the successful global launch of their products. In addition, Boating and Floating Ltd. is planning to outsource their human resource function to attain a competitive advantage. Response is to be written in the form of a business report; assessed on knowledge and understanding, applying the hypothetical business situation, and business terminology.

PART 2

Influences

Stakeholders — employers, employees, employer associations, unions, government organisations, society

20. **Learn to 1** HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Discuss the influence of government on the process of determining employment contracts.

21. **(a)** HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

1 mark

Identify TWO stakeholders of the human resource function.

STIMULUS

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

22. 22 (a) Abbotsleigh Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline the role of ONE external stakeholder who represents the interests of employees in business.

STIMULUS

The retail business, Spend More, has been rapidly expanding in the past 2 years and requires additional staff and premises. However, the increasing changes have led to conflict and uncertainty between management and employees in the workplace.

23. 21 (a) 2020 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Outline the role of ONE external stakeholder who represents the interests of employees in workplace disputes.

24. 22 (b) 2023 HSC Business Studies

3 marks

The advertisement for a store manager is shown.
Outline TWO human resource issues found in this advertisement.

STIMULUS

A job advertisement from 'Teddy Bear Store' (Est. 1990), a business that aims to bring joy to children, seeking a Store Manager.
Role: manage a team of 8 staff members; manage day-to-day operations. Responsibilities: organise inventory; train staff; assist customers. General information: \$65 000 salary; union membership not permitted; no superannuation included.

25. 23 (c) 2021 HSC Business Studies

6 marks

In recent times governments have imposed restrictions on businesses such as lockdowns, social distancing and the movement of people. As a result, businesses have changed the way their employees work and communicate with each other.

Discuss the possible implications of these influences on human resource management.

STIMULUS

Scenario: governments have recently imposed restrictions on businesses such as lockdowns, social distancing and limits on the movement of people, and as a result businesses have changed the way their employees work and communicate with each other.

Also tested by question 50.

Legal — the employment contract, common law, minimum employment standards, awards, enterprise agreements

26. Learn to 6 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Compare the process of negotiating enterprise/collective agreements with the negotiation of individual contracts.

27. 22 (c) Abbotsleigh Trial 2024

2 marks

Describe ONE common law obligation of the employers at Spend More.

STIMULUS

The retail business, Spend More, has been rapidly expanding in the past 2 years and requires additional staff and premises. However, the increasing changes have led to conflict and uncertainty between management and employees in the workplace.

28. 24 (a) Loreto Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline the purpose of the Fair Work Act.

STIMULUS

TechWorld is reviewing its human resources strategies to ensure alignment with its goals for: growth; innovation; supportive work culture; current legal framework.

29. 22 (a) 2022 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Outline how an increase in the minimum wage rate could affect business.

30. 23 (a) 2019 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Outline ONE employer obligation in an employment contract.

31. (b) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM2 marks

State ONE ‘National Employment Standard’ Mango airlines would need to adhere to.

STIMULUS

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

32. 22 (b) SIC Trial 20243 marks

Distinguish between a common law contract and an enterprise agreement.

33. 22 (b) 2022 HSC Business Studies

3 marks

Outline how the minimum employment standards protect employees in Australia. Use examples in your answer.

34. 24 (c) Newington Trial 2024

4 marks

Distinguish between awards and enterprise agreements as an employment contract

35. 23 (b) 2019 HSC Business Studies

4 marks

Distinguish between awards and enterprise agreements.

Also tested by questions 20, 24, 50, 51, 52.

Legal — work health and safety and workers compensation

36. 22 (a) SIC Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline the impact of work health and safety legislation on Australian businesses.

Also tested by questions 50, 51, 53.

Legal — anti-discrimination and equal employment opportunity

37. 24 (a) Newington Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline how anti-discrimination legislation influences human resources

38. 22 (a) 2023 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

What is the purpose of Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) legislation?

39. 23 (b) Reddam Trial 2024

4 marks

Explain ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of a business having a diverse and culturally competent workforce.

Also tested by questions 50, 51.

Economic influences

40. 21 (c) 2020 HSC Business Studies 4 marks

Explain how technological influences and globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers. Support your answer with relevant examples.

41. (d) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM 4 marks

Explain the impact of a recession on Mango Airlines human resource management.

STIMULUS

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

Also tested by questions 29, 54.

Technological influences

42. 24 (c) Loreto Trial 2024 4 marks

Analyse the impact of technological influences on ONE of the human resource processes at TechWorld.

STIMULUS

TechWorld is reviewing its human resources strategies to ensure alignment with its goals for: growth; innovation; supportive work culture; current legal framework.

43. 22 (c) SIC Trial 2024

5 marks

Describe how changes in technology impact on Human Resources processes.

Also tested by questions 25, 40, 54, 55.

Social influences — changing work patterns, living standards

44. **22 (c)** 2023 HSC Business Studies

5 marks

The table shows labour force participation rates for males and females in Australia, 1981–2021.

Explain the social influences that have contributed to the changing labour force participation rates in the period 1981–2021.

STIMULUS

Table of Australian labour force participation rates by gender: 1981 — males 78%, females 44%; 2001 — males 73%, females 55%; 2021 — males 71%, females 62%.

45. 23 (c) 2019 HSC Business Studies

5 marks

Assess the impact of ONE social influence on human resource management.

Also tested by questions 25, 39, 54.

Ethics and corporate social responsibility

46. **Learn to 2** HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Explain how businesses exhibit corporate social responsibility in the management of human resources.

47. 24 (a) Independent Trial 2024

2 marks

Define corporate social responsibility.

48. 24 (b) Newington Trial 2024

4 marks

Discuss TWO benefits for a business of embracing corporate social responsibilities and ethical practices

49. 24 (b) Independent Trial 2024

4 marks

Discuss TWO benefits for business of embracing corporate social responsibilities and ethical practices.

Also tested by questions 51, 55.

PART 2 · EXTENDED RESPONSE

Influences — 20-mark questions

6 questions. Plan and write these on separate paper.

50. Question 27 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

20 marks

Explain how stakeholders and legal influences impact on a business's human resource management.

51. Question 28 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

20 marks

Evaluate the response of human resource management to legal and ethical influences.

52. Question 25 HSC Final Exam Preparation — OPERATIONS

20 marks

You have been employed as a consultant to prepare a report for the management of Fast Car Parts Ltd. In your report:

- Outline TWO National Employment Standards the Human Resource manager should be aware of while negotiating the new enterprise agreement.
- Describe ONE influence on operations at Fast Car Parts Ltd.
- Discuss TWO appropriate operations strategies management could implement at Fast Car Parts Ltd.
- Recommend ONE profitability strategy the business could use to help increase sales or reduce expenses.

STIMULUS

Fast Car Parts Ltd is a successful producer of car parts with a number of factories throughout NSW. It is experiencing difficulties with its operations due to the rapidly changing nature of global markets and increased competition. This has led to declining sales and increasing expenses. The Human Resource manager is currently negotiating a new enterprise agreement with staff. Management are unsure about the various strategies they need to implement to solve the issues the company faces.

53. 25 Abbotsleigh Trial 2024

20 marks

You have been hired as a consultant by Cozy Corner Cafe to write a business report for the owners. In your report:

- Outline the advantages and disadvantages of holding stock this business should consider in its operations.
- Explain the importance of compliance with work health and safety legislation and workers compensation for this business.
- Recommend operations processes that Cozy Corner Cafe can implement to address the concerns of customers.

STIMULUS

Cozy Corner Cafe operates a café in Wahroonga renowned for its coffee and homemade pastries. The business is looking to expand its menu with a new selection of healthy breakfast items. Recent customer feedback has highlighted issues with inconsistent coffee quality and long wait times, prompting the café to address these concerns. Additionally, employees have raised concerns that the cramped kitchen space poses significant health and safety risks, including a higher likelihood of accidents, difficulties in maintaining cleanliness, and challenges with proper ventilation and fire safety. Answer in the form of a business report.

54. Question 26 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

20 marks

Analyse the response of human resource management to economic, technological and social influences.

55. 26 Reddam Trial 2024

20 marks

Analyse the impact of corporate social responsibility and technological influences on human resource management.

PART 3

Processes of human resource management

Acquisition

56. 22 (d) 2022 HSC Business Studies

3 marks

Explain the importance of carrying out an induction program for new employees.

57. 23 (c) Reddam Trial 2024

4 marks

Explain how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.

58. 21 (c) Newington Trial 2023

5 marks

Discuss the strategy of internal recruitment for Raj.

STIMULUS

Raj owns a business that designs security software. His business is rapidly expanding due to the increase in companies allowing their employees to work from home. Raj needs to increase his workforce to keep up with his demand. The work is complicated and requires excellent knowledge of coding and software design. Due to the expansion, Raj requires more employees in management roles.

Also tested by questions 17, 42, 60, 61, 62, 63.

Development

No short-answer question of its own. Covered inside questions 17, 42, 43, 57, 60, 63, 64.

Maintenance

No short-answer question of its own. Covered inside questions 57, 61, 62, 64.

Separation — voluntary and involuntary

59. 21 (b) 2020 HSC Business Studies

4 marks

Distinguish between voluntary and involuntary separation.

Also tested by questions 40, 57, 65.

PART 3 · EXTENDED RESPONSE

Processes of human resource management — 20-mark questions

6 questions. Plan and write these on separate paper.

60. 27 Loreto Trial 2024

20 marks

Assess the significance of effective acquisition and development processes in reducing workplace disputes and increasing worker satisfaction.

61. 25 2023 HSC Business Studies

20 marks

The directors have asked you to write a business report in which you:

- outline some of the challenges including the global factors of costs, skills and supply the business may need to consider in recruiting and retaining staff
- compare the use of debt and equity as sources of finance
- recommend ONE source of finance this business could use to fund its expansion.

STIMULUS

Future Century Gaming Pty Ltd operates an online gaming platform targeting players aged 18–40 in Australia. It has been in operation since 2012, providing subscription access to a variety of online games. The business is considering expanding into emerging global markets but is finding it challenging to recruit and retain skilled, qualified game designers and developers in Australia. It is considering international labour markets to overcome staff shortages. The business has decided to finance its expansion into global markets through external sources. Answer is to be presented as a business report.

62. 27 2021 HSC Business Studies

20 marks

Analyse how human resource management strategies can improve the process of employee acquisition and maintenance.

63. 2019 HSC
Question 25

2021 Finance Practice HSC Questions · HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM · 2019
HSC Business Studies

20 marks

You have been hired as a consultant to write a report for the owners. In your report:

- discuss methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff
- recommend TWO appropriate working capital management strategies for this business.

STIMULUS

Case scenario (business report): A business, Roo's Outback Eatery Pty Ltd, is opening an additional restaurant in NSW. They plan to position the restaurant as an exclusive restaurant specialising in modern Australian food with quality customer service. The owners require assistance with the following: the acquisition and development of suitable staff; additional funds for the day-to-day running of the business; the close monitoring of working capital.

64. 25 Reddam Trial 2023**20 marks**

You have been employed as a consultant to write a business report to the owners of Natural Life Ltd. In your report:

- Outline the relationship between cost and quality in the operations of Natural Life.
- Recommend ONE human resource process that could be used to address the current issues of Natural Life.
- Evaluate TWO operation strategies Natural Life could adopt to achieve flexibility and dependability performance objectives.

STIMULUS

Business report scenario — Natural Life: an Australian manufacturer of a range of expensive herbal vitamins and nutritional supplements. The business sources their inputs from local suppliers and undertakes production in their factories throughout Australia. However, Natural Life have received complaints from customers regarding the poor quality of their products and their slow response to customer complaints. Also, there have been media reports concerning the large number of accidents and staff injuries occurring in their factories.

65. 25 2021 HSC Business Studies**20 marks**

You have been hired as a consultant by Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd to write a business report to the owners. In your report:

- outline TWO operations influences affecting this business
- discuss the use of retraining and redundancy payments to help overcome employee resistance to these changes
- compare the use of a mortgage to a new issue of shares to fund the factory purchase.

STIMULUS

Hypothetical business: Ozzi Baby Food Pty Ltd has a trusted reputation in domestic and global markets due to its safe and sustainably-sourced product range, which has led to a significant increase in demand. It is considering purchasing a larger automated factory, which will lead to some job losses. External finance is required to fund the purchase, using either a mortgage or becoming a public company on the Australian Securities Exchange (ASX). The response must be presented as a business report.

PART 4

Strategies in human resource management

Leadership style

66. 21 (a) Newington Trial 2023

2 marks

Identify TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business.

67. 23 (b) Knox Trial 2023

6 marks

Justify the use of rewards and leadership style as strategies to improve the effectiveness of human resource management for this business.

STIMULUS

HiFashion is a fast fashion retail store with 40 stores around Australia employing 200 staff. Management is concerned about a reduction in productivity and staff feedback; staff cited rewards, leadership style and dispute resolution methods as key to their dissatisfaction. Data extract: staff turnover 10% (2021) to 20% (2022); employee satisfaction 80% (2021) to 65% (2022); number of disputes 10 per year (2021) to 25 per year (2022).

Also tested by question 79.

Recruitment — internal or external, general or specific skills

No short-answer question of its own. Covered inside questions 10, 58, 62, 63, 80, 81.

Training and development — current or future skills

68. Learn to 8 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Evaluate the effectiveness of human resource management for one business and recommend appropriate alternative strategies.

69. (c) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

3 marks

Discuss ONE training and development strategy Mango airlines could use to train and develop its staff.

STIMULUS

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

Also tested by questions 14, 63, 65, 79, 80, 82, 83, 84, 85.

Performance management — developmental or administrative

70. 22 (c) 2022 HSC Business Studies

3 marks

How are performance appraisals of employees beneficial to employers?

Also tested by questions 79, 80, 81, 84.

Rewards — monetary and non-monetary, individual or group, performance pay

71. 23 (b) Reddam Trial 2023

3 marks

Explain ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management.

Also tested by questions 62, 67, 68, 79, 80, 82, 84, 85, 86.

Global — costs, competencies

72. Learn to 4 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Examine the advantages of a diverse, culturally competent workforce for a global business.

Also tested by questions 6, 61.

Workplace disputes — negotiation, mediation, grievance procedures, courts and tribunals

73. Learn to 3 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

Analyse the causes of two workplace disputes and the strategies used to resolve them.

74. 23 (a) Reddam Trial 2024

2 marks

Describe ONE strategy that can be used to resolve a workplace dispute in a business.

75. 21 (b) Newington Trial 2023

3 marks

Describe the role of grievance procedures in human resource management.

76. 23 (a) Knox Trial 2023

4 marks

Explain how HiFashion could implement TWO appropriate dispute resolution methods that would reduce the current number of disputes.

STIMULUS

HiFashion is a fast fashion retail store with 40 stores around Australia employing 200 staff. Management is concerned about a reduction in productivity and staff feedback; staff cited rewards, leadership style and dispute resolution methods as key to their dissatisfaction. Data extract: staff turnover 10% (2021) to 20% (2022); employee satisfaction 80% (2021) to 65% (2022); number of disputes 10 per year (2021) to 25 per year (2022).

77. 23 (c) Reddam Trial 2023

5 marks

Using a business case study, analyse the cause of one workplace dispute and the strategies used to resolve this dispute.

78. Question 22 (b) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

6 marks

Analyse the methods this business could use to resolve the disputes between employers and employees.

STIMULUS

A manufacturing business operating across Australia employs a large workforce. Management decides to outsource key human resource functions including recruitment, induction, change management, training and development of employees. Recently there has been an industrial dispute with employees demanding higher pay, and better working conditions.

Also tested by questions 23, 60, 83, 84, 86.

PART 4 · EXTENDED RESPONSE

Strategies in human resource management — 20-mark questions

8 questions. Plan and write these on separate paper.

79. 26 Newington Trial 2024

20 marks

Analyse how human resources management strategies can be used to improve human resource indicators

80. 27 SIC Trial 2024

20 marks

To what extent do human resources strategies impact business objectives?

81. 25 Knox Trial 2023

20 marks

You have been hired as a consultant by Delicious Burgers to write a business report for the owners. In your report:

- describe the influence of quality expectations as part of its operations function that Delicious Burgers must consider as it expands into new markets.
- discuss the use of holding stock as part of their inventory management in each location.
- assess the human resource management strategies of recruitment and performance management to help achieve its forecasted growth objectives.

STIMULUS

Delicious Burgers is a successful Australian high-quality fast-food business which started in 2010 in Manly, Sydney and now operates in more than 30 locations in NSW and Queensland, employing 250 staff. It offers burgers and associated meals including desserts. Restaurants are fitted out so customers feel they are in a beach shack with a relaxed atmosphere. Key to its success has been experienced staff such as knowledgeable chefs and wait staff with excellent customer service skills; staff turnover is very low at 3% (industry average 20%).

Delicious Burgers has always sourced the freshest ingredients available and every burger is made to order. The business is expanding to new locations in Western Australia and must hire 50 staff. It has forecast a revenue growth rate of 40% for the next financial year. Management is considering: quality expectations of its goods and service offering; whether to hold inventory in each location; and human resource strategies, specifically recruitment and performance management.

82. 26 Independent Trial 2024**20 marks**

Analyse how human resources management strategies can be used to address increases in staff turnover and improve worker satisfaction.

83. 25 Newington Trial 2023**20 marks**

You have been hired as a consultant to write a report for Fly Well Airlines Ltd.

In your report:

- Outline ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of outsourcing aircraft servicing and maintenance.
- Discuss issues involved in raising funds through both debt and equity finance and make a recommendation to management about which source of funding to use.
- Explain TWO human resource strategies that could assist Fly Well Airlines Ltd to address management concerns and help achieve business success.

STIMULUS

Fly Well Airlines Ltd is a low-cost Australian based domestic airline that has been exploring options to expand globally. Its domestic customers in Australia typically tend to be business executives and budget conscious leisure travellers. The business intends to begin operating flights into the highly competitive Asian market in the latter part of 2023. To achieve this, the business will have to fund the purchase of new computerised ticketing and baggage facilities at its Sydney terminal. Management believes there is also opportunity for the airline to move all scheduled aircraft servicing and maintenance to a contractor in Singapore. Employees who belong to unions have indicated they will respond to this with industrial action. Management is also concerned about the best way to achieve a sustainable competitive advantage in their new overseas markets.

84. Question 27 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM · 2020 HSC Business Studies**20 marks**

Evaluate human resource strategies used to achieve THREE indicators of effective human resource management.

85. Question 25 HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM**20 marks**

Write a report for the directors of Fast Burgers Ltd in which you:

- describe the role of operations management for this business
- demonstrate why corporate social responsibility should remain a key concern in the operation of this business
- recommend THREE human resource strategies that Fast Burgers Ltd could use to maintain its record as an excellent employer

STIMULUS

Fast Burgers Ltd is a large fast food business that has been operating for 15 years in a market with high levels of competition. Recently Fast Burgers Ltd has offered its employees an extra day of annual leave in order to participate in charity work. This has been popular among staff, and the business publishes a short summary of these activities on its social media sites. Additionally Fast Burgers Ltd received an award for its services to its staff and to society. Similar businesses are now adopting this approach, so Fast Burgers Ltd is considering what else can be done to maintain its record as an excellent employer.

86. 26 2022 HSC Business Studies**20 marks**

Explain the importance to a business of having human resources strategies that reduce workplace disputes and increase worker satisfaction.

PART 5

Effectiveness of human resource management

Indicators — corporate culture, benchmarking key variables, changes in staff turnover, absenteeism, accidents, levels of disputation, worker satisfaction

87. 24 (a) Barker Trial 2023 2 marks

Define corporate culture.

88. 23 (a) Reddam Trial 2023 2 marks

Outline ONE indicator that can be used to measure the effectiveness of human resource management in a business.

89. 23 (a) 2021 HSC Business Studies 2 marks

Outline how corporate culture can affect staff turnover.

90. 24 (b) Barker Trial 2024

3 marks

Why is corporate culture an indicator of the effectiveness of human resource management?

91. 24 (c) Independent Trial 2024

4 marks

Explain how TWO indicators can be used to evaluate the effectiveness of the human resource function.

92. 22 (d) Abbotsleigh Trial 2024

4 marks

Recommend TWO indicators that could be used by Spend More to measure the effectiveness of its human resource management.

STIMULUS

The retail business, Spend More, has been rapidly expanding in the past 2 years and requires additional staff and premises. However, the increasing changes have led to conflict and uncertainty between management and employees in the workplace.

93. 24 (b) Loreto Trial 2024

4 marks

Recommend TWO indicators that could be used by TechWorld to measure the effectiveness of its human resource management.

STIMULUS

TechWorld is reviewing its human resources strategies to ensure alignment with its goals for: growth; innovation; supportive work culture; current legal framework.

94. 24 (b) Abbotsleigh Trial 2023

4 marks

To what extent is human resources management effective in this business? Support your answer with examples from the data.

STIMULUS

Table of data for a business, 2021 vs 2022. Human Resources costs: \$2 600 000 (2021) vs \$2 000 000 (2022). Training expenditure per employee: \$1900 vs \$1500. Absenteeism per employee: 10 days vs 14 days. Accidents per 1000 employees: 50 vs 30. Number of strike days: 2 vs 10. Staff turnover: 15% vs 10%.

95. 24 (c) Barker Trial 2023 · Barker Trial 2024

5 marks

Evaluate the effectiveness of human resources management at this business.

STIMULUS

Table of data for a business between 2022 and 2023: Absenteeism per employee 10 days (2022) rising to 15 days (2023); Staff turnover 15% rising to 18%; Training expenditure per employee \$2 100 rising to \$3 400; Accidents per 100 employees falling from 11 to 5.

Also tested by questions 14, 60, 67, 68, 79, 82, 84, 86.